C-C-271H

July 17, 1973

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec.
C-C-00271G (Army-GL)
March 30, 1971 and
Fed. Spec. C-C-271F
March 22, 1967

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHEESE, CHEDDAR, NATURAL

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for natural cheddar cheese for the use of all Federal agencies.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Natural cheddar cheese. Natural cheddar cheese covered by this specification shall be of the following grades, classes, and styles, as specified (see 6.2).

1.2.2 Grades. The cheddar cheese shall conform to the requirements of the following grades, as specified (see 3.3).

U.S. Grade A or better.
U.S. Grade B.

1.2.3 Classes. The cheddar cheese shall be of the following classes, as specified (see 3.3).

Class 1 - Fresh or current (pasteurized, minimum age - 30 days)
(unpasteurized - see 3.2.3.2).
Class 2 - Medium cured (minimum age - 3 months).
Class 3 - Cured or aged (minimum age - 9 months).

1.2.4 Styles and sizes. The cheddar cheese shall be of the following styles and sizes, as specified.

FSC 8910

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Styles	Approximate weight, pounds
(a) Cheddars	70-78
(b) Flat or twins	32-37
(c) Daisies or triplets	20-25
(d) Longhorns	11-13
(e) Print loaves	5
(f) Rindless cheese; cheddar	

Sizes

(1) 80-pound block
(2) 60-pound block
(3) 40-pound block
(4) 40-pound precut as specified into -
two 20-pound loaves
four 10-pound loaves
eight 5-pound loaves
(5) 20-pound loaves
(6) 10-pound loaves

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-D-723 - Drums, Fiber.
PPP-B-1163 - Box, Corrugated, Fiberboard, High Compression Strength Weather-Resistant, Wax-Resin Impregnated.

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-101 - Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Materials: Test Procedures.
FED-STD-123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

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(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-1162	-	Sanitary Standards for Cheese and Cheese Products Plants.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

PUBLICATIONS:

U.S. Department of Health, Education, and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture

General Specifications for Dairy Plants Approved for USDA Inspection and Grading Service

Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service

U.S. Standards for Grades of Cheddar Cheese

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Dairy Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, D.C. 20250.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

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Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods for Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Post Office Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, D.C. 20044.)

American Public Health Association, Inc.

Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Public Health Association, Inc., 1015 18th Street, N.W., Washington, D.C. 20036.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, D.C. 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for references from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Milk. The raw milk used in the preparation of these products shall be drawn from cows in herds accredited as tuberculosis-free and certified brucellosis-free by the U.S. Department of Agriculture, or herds that have passed an annual tuberculosis test and meet USDA requirements for an individually certified herd, or from cows in herds located in:

(1) A modified accredited tuberculosis area; and
(2) Either (a) A certified brucellosis-free area; or
(b) Modified certified brucellosis area; or
(3) An area in the process of being accredited or certified by the USDA.

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The milk shall be practically free from colostrum, shall be fresh, wholesome, and normal in appearance and odor, and shall be subject to inspection by the procuring agency or duly authorized representative.

3.1.1.1 Bacterial and sediment requirements. The raw milk supply shall comply with the minimum bacterial and sediment requirements for acceptable milk set forth in the General Specifications for Dairy Plants Approved for USDA Inspection and Grading Service.

3.1.2 Color. Coloring, if used, shall be Annatto or any cheese or butter color permitted by the Definitions and Standards of Identity for Cheese and Cheese Products under the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act.

3.1.3 Salt. Salt shall be white, refined, sodium chloride of food grade quality, free from extraneous material.

3.1.4 Calcium chloride. Calcium chloride, if used, shall be of the purified form (food grade), and shall not exceed 0.02 percent, calculated as anhydrous calcium chloride, of the weight of the milk.

3.2 Preparation.

3.2.1 Milk. The milk used in the manufacture of the cheddar cheese may be pasteurized or unpasteurized.

3.2.2 Pasteurization of milk. Milk, if to be pasteurized, shall be heated to a temperature of not less than 145°F. for not less than 30 minutes or at a temperature of not less than 161°F. for not less than 15 seconds, or by some other recognized method of pasteurization which gives equivalent results acceptable to local and state regulatory or Federal authority. Alternatively, the milk may be treated with hydrogen peroxide solution/catalase preparation in accordance with the Definitions and Standards for Cheddar Cheese.

3.2.2.1 The cheddar cheese shall be deemed not to have been made from pasteurized milk if the test results using the procedure referenced in 4.5.1.1 show a value of 1 microgram or more of phenol per milliliter of cheese extract. The phosphatase test is not applicable to cheese manufactured from milk treated with hydrogen peroxide/catalase preparation.

3.2.3 Finished product.

3.2.3.1 Cheddar cheese. Cheddar cheese is cheese made by the Cheddar process or by another procedure which produces a finished cheese having the same physical and chemical properties as the cheese produced by the cheddar process and is made from cow's milk with or without the addition of coloring matter and with common salt, contains not more than 39 percent of moisture, and in the water-free substance, contains not less than 50 percent of milkfat and conforms to the provisions of the Definitions and Standards for Cheddar Cheese, U.S. Food and Drug Administration.

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3.2.3.2 Unpasteurized milk cheese. When the milk used is not pasteurized, the cheese so made shall be cured at a temperature of not less than 35°F. for not less than 60 days from date of manufacture.

3.2.3.3 Rindless cheese. Rindless cheese shall be prepared by pressing into block forms without bandages or paraffin and shall be free from rind development. The cheese shall be properly wrapped in a wrapper or covering, or by any other means of handling which will not impart any color or objectionable odor or flavor to the cheese. The wrapper or covering shall be sealed with a sufficient overlap or satisfactory closing to prevent air leakage. The wrapper or covering shall be of sufficient low permeability to water vapor and air, so as to prevent the formation of rind and prevent the entrance of air during the curing and holding periods.

3.2.3.4 Force-cured cheese. Cheddar cheese which has been subjected to a curing technique commonly referred to as force-cured, shelf-cured, or warm-cured, shall not be acceptable. These methods of curing are defined as conditions in which the cheese is subjected to curing at temperatures in excess of 50°F.

3.3 Grades and classes. The interpretation of the requirements (descriptive terms) for grades of natural cheddar cheese shall be as defined in the United States Standards for Grades of Cheddar Cheese. The natural cheddar cheese shall conform to the requirements for U.S. grade A, or better, or grade B as specified (6.2). At the option of the seller, U.S. grade AA is acceptable as a substitute for U.S. grade A. At time of grading, class 1 shall conform to the specifications of fresh or current in the United States Standards for Grades of Cheddar Cheese; class 2 shall conform to the specifications for medium-cured; and class 3 shall conform to the specifications of cured or aged, as specified (see 6.2), in addition to meeting the minimum age requirements specified in 1.2.3.

3.3.1 Age at time of grading. All cheese in the inspection lot at time of grading shall be not less than the specified age (see 1.2.3), except that cheese made from unpasteurized milk shall be not less than 60 days old (see 3.2.3.2), at time of grading.

3.4 Plant qualification. The product shall originate, be processed, handled, packaged and stored in plants which are approved under the USDA General Specifications for Dairy Plants Approved for USDA Inspection and Grading Service, and listed by the U.S. Department of Agriculture in the document titled Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service, and approved for the finished product described in this specification, or in plants meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-1162.

3.5 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government.

4.1.1 Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be complete and made available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling. Samples of the finished product covered by this specification, and samples of any materials, components, or constituents entering into the preparation of the finished product may be taken at any time by the Government inspector to determine compliance with the requirements.

4.3 Inspection.

4.3.1 General. Inspections shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be at the dairy farm or milk plant, both during and after processing, at any point in transit, or after delivery at the point of destination.

4.3.2 Factory inspection. The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials shall not relieve the supplier of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.3.3 Final inspection. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2) final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination.

4.3.4 Condition inspection of containers. When inspection of product for quality and condition is performed by the U.S. Department of Agriculture, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers shall apply for the condition inspection of containers. (For applicable criteria governing inspection of containers for the military, see 4.4.4.)

4.3.5 Plant qualification conditions. The product furnished under this document shall be unacceptable if not produced and stored in plants which currently meet the qualification conditions of 3.4.

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4.4 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards, unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1.1 Inspection of milk and milk products.

4.4.1.1.1 Animal sources. Inspection shall be made to determine that cows supplying the milk used in the preparation of this product are in herds designated by the U.S. Department of Agriculture as tuberculosis-free and from herds designated brucellosis-free or in the process of being so designated. Determination of herd status regarding tuberculosis and brucellosis shall be made by contacting the nearest office of the Agricultural Research Service of the Animal Health Division. (Location of this office may be ascertained by consulting the publication entitled Directory of Consumer Protection Programs, Establishments, Circuits and Officials.) Nonconformance to either of the above requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4.1.1.2 Establishment sources. Examination shall be made to determine that all milk supplies used in the manufacture of the finished product have been handled, processed, packaged and shipped by establishments approved as military sources of supply as listed in the Directory of Sanitarily Approved Food Establishments for Armed Forces Procurement or listed by the U.S. Department of Agriculture in the document titled: Dairy Plants Surveyed and Approved for USDA Grading Service and approved for the product to be used in the manufacture of the finished product specified in this document. Nonconformance to the aforementioned establishment sources shall be cause for rejection of the milk supply or the involved quantity of finished product made therefrom, as applicable.

4.4.1.1.3 Examination of raw whole milk. Examination and testing of raw whole milk shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.1.1 as concerns animal health, appearance and odor and with the referenced requirements of 3.1.1.1 as concerns bacterial and sediment content. Records of all required examinations and tests shall be maintained and made available for review. Failure to comply with one or more of the above referenced requirements, reflected by actual examination and tests or by examination of records, shall be cause for rejection of the involved lot of finished product.

4.4.1.2 Examination of color, salt and calcium chloride. Conformance of these non-dairy ingredients to the requirements of 3.1.2 through 3.1.4 as concerns identity (kind, grade, etc.) shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, invoices or other valid documents. In addition, salt shall be examined organoleptically, as necessary, to determine conformance to the

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applicable condition requirements of 3.1.3. The sample for examination shall be approximately 8 ounces of product derived from each of 5 primary containers or all containers if less than 5 form a lot. Nonconformance to one or more identity or condition requirements shall indicate an unacceptable ingredient(s) and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

4.4.2 Testing of components. Testing of components described in this specification shall be as shown in table I. Results shall be applicable to the lot average. Nonconformance to one or more test requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE I. Testing of components 1/

Component	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	Characteristics	Results reported to	Test ref. and rqmt. para.
Wrapper	Sheet	Reams	S-1	Wax content	Nearest 1 lb per ream	4.5.2 5.1.1.2.1 5.1.1.2.4
				Thermoplastic coating	Nearest 1 lb per ream	5.1.1.2.2
				Thickness 2/		
				Polyvinylidene chloride-vinyl chloride copolymer plastic film	Nearest 0.0001 inch	5.1.1.2.3
				Aluminum foil	Nearest 0.00001 inch	5.1.1.2.4
Chipboard pads	Two 12 by 12 inch panels	Fiberboard boxes	S-1	Chipboard thickness	Nearest 0.001 inch	4.5.3 5.2.1.1.1
				Chipboard weight	Nearest 1 lb per 1000 sq. ft.	4.5.4 5.2.1.1.1

1/ See 4.4.1.

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2/ In lieu of performing test for thickness, conformance to requirements may be ascertained by examination of labels, invoices or other valid documents.

4.4.3 Process examination. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), examination shall be performed during processing to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.1.4, as concerns formulation and of 3.2.2, 3.2.3.2, and 3.2.3.4, as concerns time, temperature and curing procedure. All pertinent control records shall be maintained. Nonconformance to one or more of the above mentioned referenced requirements reflected by actual examination or by records, shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of finished product.

4.4.4 Examination of end item. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with table III and 4.4.4.1 through 4.4.4.3.3. The examination criteria shall be as shown in table II. The acceptable quality levels (AQL's) shall be expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. End item examination criteria

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQL's Major	AQL's Total
III	S-3	1 shipping container	Shipping containers	1.5	6.5

TABLE III. Examination of packing 1/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
151		Not type container specified.
	201	More than 60 pounds of product packed as indicated by marked net weight. (Applicable to styles (b), (c), (d), (e), and (f) (2) through (f) (4).)
	202	More than 4 pieces of a style of cheese. (Applicable to styles (b), (c), and (d).)
	203	Metal stitches (when applicable) not covered as specified.
	204	More than 80 pounds of product packed as indicated by marked net weight. (Applicable to style (f) (1).)

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TABLE III. Examination of packing 1/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
	205	More than 78 pounds of product packed as indicated by marked net weight. (Applicable to style (a).)
152		Liner, scaleboard or chipboard missing (as applicable).
	206	Containers not completely lined (when applicable).
	207	Liner material not type specified.
	208	Not a snug fit.
	209	Scaleboard(s) not placed as specified (see 5.2.1.2).
153		Not type of wood specified (see 5.2.1.1.2).
154		Plywood drum (body, top and bottom) not constructed as specified (see 5.2.1.2.2).
155		Fiberboard drum not strapped as specified (see 5.2.1.2.3).

1/ See also 4.4.4.1 for supplemental quality assurance provisions.

4.4.4.1 Examination of filled and sealed shipping container. Examination of the filled and sealed shipping container shall be made in accordance with the examination criteria contained in PPP-B-621, PPP-B-585, PPP-D-723, PPP-B-1163, or in the appendix to PPP-B-636, as applicable. In addition, the following defect shall be included in the table of examination: major: marking missing, incorrect or illegible. Examination of level C packing shall be in accordance with any one of the aforementioned specifications, contingent on the type of container used, except that only the defect for marking shall apply.

4.4.4.2 Determination of conformance to grade, class, style and age at time of grading. Examination shall be made to determine conformance to the requirements of 3.3, 3.3.1 and 5.2.1.2, as concerns grade, class, style and

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age at time of grading. This determination shall be ascertained by inspection for the presence of the applicable USDA certificate(s) of grade (or grade mark), cure (or class -- see also, 1.2.3) and date of grading. Pertinent records relating to date of grading shall be made available for review. One primary container from each vat lot (see 4.4.4.3.1) shall be inspected for grade, class, age and style (see 6.2). Examination shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.3.3. Nonconformance to one or more of the above referenced requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4.4.3 Examination for net weight. Examination for net weight shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.3.1 and 4.4.4.3.2.

4.4.4.3.1 Lot size. An inspection lot shall be expressed in terms of primary containers. Each vat lot shall be labeled (see 5.3). Date of manufacture of the youngest cheese in the lot shall establish compliance with the age requirements of the class specified (see 1.2.3). More than one factory's production may be included in the inspection lot. The number of cases for each vat by factory represented in the lot shall be known and the production dates shall be within 60 days of one another.

4.4.4.3.2 Examination of the net weight shall be in accordance with the following procedure. The sample size shall be one shipping case from each vat lot represented in the inspection lot but, in any event, not less than four shipping cases per inspection lot. The sample unit to be weighed shall be the cheese, including wrappers, contained in the shipping case. The weight of the sample unit, less the tare weight of the liner and shipping case, shall be equal to or greater than the marked weight. (Note: In determination of net weight when product is delivered in the intact package, i.e. plastic wrapper or bag, in which cured, such packaging will not be considered part of the tare weight.) If the weight of a sample unit is two pounds or more under the marked weight, the shortage for the applicable vat lot shall be calculated by multiplying the test shortage (converted to decimals), by the number of containers in the vat lot. The total net weight for the inspection lot shall be the sum of the marked weights for each vat corrected for any test shortage.

4.4.4.3.3 The cheese shall be sampled for grading by using a cheese trier having a blade with semi-circular tapered cutting edge 5-1/2 to 6 inches long. The upper end of the blade is at least 3/4 inch in diameter, and the lower end is about 5/8 inch in diameter.

4.4.5 Sampling procedures and acceptance criteria for testing finished product. When required, (see 6.2), the finished product shall be tested for the analytical characteristics specified in 3.2.3.1 and for residual phosphatase on cheese made from pasteurized milk (see 5.3.1.1 for identification). Procedures for testing shall be in accordance with 4.5. The sample for testing shall be an approximate 16-ounce composite of aliquot portions of standard trier plugs of cheese. The composite shall be derived from the number of cheeses in each vat lot indicated by inspection level S-2. Analytical results shall be reported to the nearest one percent. Phosphatase test results

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shall be reported as pass or fail. The lot shall be rejected if one or more test results indicate noncompliance with the requirements.

4.5 Test methods. Test procedures which differ from those specified herein, unless otherwise excepted, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum such quality assurance, the supplier will use the procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to test results, the procedures specified herein will govern.

4.5.1 Chemical analyses. Chemical analyses, if required by purchaser, (see 6.2) shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, chapter: Dairy Products, section: Cheese.

4.5.1.1 Phosphatase. Compliance with the phosphatase requirement shall be determined by the Scharer Rapid Phosphatase Test as outlined in Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products, chapter: Phosphatase Methods to Determine Pasteurization.

4.5.2 Test for wax in wrappers. The weight of wax in the wrapper shall be determined in accordance with method 6018 of FED-STD-101.

4.5.3 Thickness of chipboard. Thickness shall be determined in accordance with method 1003 of FED-STD-101.

4.5.4 Basis weight of chipboard. Basis weight shall be determined in accordance with method 5022 or FED-STD-101.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level B. The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1.1 or 5.1.1.2, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1.1 Bandaged and paraffin-dipped cheese. Each style (a), (b), (c), (d) and (e) cheese shall be bandaged and dipped in a refined paraffin, amorphous wax, microcrystalline wax, or any combination of such or any other suitable substance. Such coating shall be a continuous, unbroken and uniform film adhering tightly to the entire surface of the cheese.

5.1.1.2 Rindless cheese. The style (f) cheese of the size specified shall be packaged and cured in one of the materials described in 5.1.1.2.1 through 5.1.1.2.4. The wrapper shall be free of plasticizers, stabilizers, or other

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agents which impart objectionable odors, flavors, or color to the cheese. The wrapper shall adequately and securely envelop the cheese, conform closely to its shape, be unbroken, practically free of wrinkles, and fully protect the surface. When specified (see 6.2), individual precut loaves shall be packaged in the material specified in 5.1.1.2.1 or 5.1.1.2.3.

5.1.1.2.1 The wrapper shall consist of one sheet of 300 MAT-2, 300 MB-2, or 300 MB-1 cellophane laminated with a minimum of 8 pounds per ream (24 by 36-500) of amorphous wax to one sheet of 300 MAT-2 or 300 MB-1 cellophane. The laminated sheet shall then be coated on one side with 40 pounds per ream (24 by 36-500) of amorphous wax combination (see 4.5.2). The wrapper shall be large enough to cover the cheese completely with an overlap of approximately 1/2 inch at the seams. The wrapper shall be heat sealed.

5.1.1.2.2 The wrapper shall consist of one sheet of 450 K 202 cellophane coated with a copolymer of vinylidene - vinyl chloride on both sides and a thermoplastic coating of 45-50 pounds per ream on one side. The wrapper shall be large enough to cover the cheese completely with an overlap of approximately one inch. The wrapper shall be heat sealed.

5.1.1.2.3 The wrapper shall consist of one sheet of polyvinylidene chloride-vinyl chloride copolymer plastic film not less than 0.001 inch thick. The sheet shall be large enough to cover the cheese completely and to overlap at the seams at least one inch. The wrapper shall be shrunk tightly to the cheese by application of heat to all surfaces of the wrapped block of cheese. The packaged cheese may be wrapped in a sheet of waxed glassine, waxed bleached, or semibleached deodorized kraft, or waxed sulphite paper to protect the plastic film during subsequent handling.

5.1.1.2.4 The wrapper shall consist of one sheet of 0.00035 inch thick aluminum foil laminated with not less than 5 pounds per ream (24 by 36-500) of combination of microcrystalline wax, modified microcrystalline wax, or wax base combinations on each side to one of the cellophanes described in 5.1.1.2.1. After lamination, the combined sheet shall be coated with not less than 37 pounds per ream of one of these waxes (see 4.5.2). The wrapper shall be large enough to provide adequate closures, with an overlap of not less than 1/2 inch at the seams, and shall be heat sealed.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. No material shall be used in the packaging of the product which will impart an odor or flavor to the cheese. Interior containers shall be sound and clear and shall adequately protect the contents from contamination. The supplier's commercial practice may be used if it fulfills these requirements.

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5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.2). Shipping containers shall be new (not previously used), except that if the container is employed as the curing box as well as the shipping container, it shall be considered a new shipping container.

5.2.1 Level B. The product shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.1.1 or 5.2.1.2.

5.2.1.1 Print loaves and rindless cheese.

5.2.1.1.1 Fiberboard box. Not more than 60 pounds of style (e) or (f) (2) through (f) (4) products or 1 block of style (f) (1) product shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box made, sealed, and strapped in accordance with style FTC or RSC, V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. If FTC style boxes are used the body flaps shall be stapled on the outsides of the body. If metal stitches are used for the bottom flaps, the bottom shall be covered with a pad of chipboard not less than 0.018 inch thick and weighing not less than 70 pounds per 1000 square feet. The shipping container shall be completely lined top, bottom, sides, and ends with waxed, bleached, semibleached, unbleached deodorized kraft, waxed sulphite paper, or waxed glassine. If the loaves or packages of cheese are already wrapped in waxed paper, the shipping container need not be lined with waxed paper. If the packaged cheeses are in waxed chipboard or waxed corrugated cartons, the chipboard pads may be omitted and the shipping container need not be lined with waxed paper.

5.2.1.1.1.1 Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, type SWCFI, grade 275, of PPP-B-1163. Closure shall be with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The shipping container shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.1.2 Nailed wood box. Alternatively, not more than 60 pounds of style (e) or (f) (2) through (f) (4) products or 1 block of style (f) (1) product may be packed in a snug-fitting nailed wood box, constructed and strapped in accordance with style 4, class 2, for type 2 load of PPP-B-621, except that the boxes shall not be made from cedar (all kinds) alpine fir, balsam fir, or noble fir. The interior of each box shall be inspected prior to packing the cheese, and splinters or nails that might damage the wrappers or the product shall be removed. The boxes shall be completely lined top, bottom, sides, and ends with waxed, bleached, semibleached, unbleached deodorized kraft, waxed sulphite paper, or waxed glassine. If the packaged cheeses are already wrapped in waxed paper or in waxed chipboard or waxed corrugated cartons, the shipping container need not be lined with waxed paper.

5.2.1.1.3 Wirebound wood box. Alternatively, not more than 60 pounds of style (e) or (f) (2) through (f) (4) products or 1 block of style (f) (1)

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product, packed in waxed fiberboard containers commercially used for the product, may be packed in a snug-fitting wirebound wood box constructed and closed in accordance with class 2, style 1, 2, or 3, type 2 load of PPP-B-585.

5.2.1.2 Longhorns, daisies, flats, and cheddars. Not more than 4 pieces of style (b), (c) or (d) cheese totaling not more than 60 pounds or 1 piece of style (a) cheese, shall be packed in a snug-fitting nailed wood box, a plywood cheese drum, a fiberboard cheese drum, or a wirebound wood box as specified in 5.2.1.2.1 through 5.2.1.2.4, respectively. One scale board shall be placed on top and one under the bottom of the cheese. When two or more cheeses are packed together, an additional scaleboard shall be placed between the cheeses.

5.2.1.2.1 Nailed wood box. The product shall be packed in a nailed wood box constructed, inspected, lined, and strapped in accordance with 5.2.1.1.2.

5.2.1.2.2 Plywood drum. The body of the drum shall be made of two plies of hardwood veneer, each not less than 1/12 inch in thickness, firmly glued together, with the grain of the outside ply parallel and the grain of the inner ply vertical to the drumheads. The body shall be butt-jointed and shall be fastened to the outside with a 28-gage steel strip not less than 1-1/2 inches in width. Seventeen gage staples shall be driven on each side of the joint, spaced not more than 1-1/2 inches apart, and clinched on the inside of the body. The clinched staples shall be covered on the inside with a strip of tape, to prevent damage to the cheese. Both top and bottom plies shall be three plies of hardwood veneer, each not less than 1/12 inch in thickness, all firmly glued together with the grain of each outside ply at right angles to the grain of the center ply. Both top and bottom heads shall be held in place with steel hoops made from 28-gage 1-7/16 inch wide flanged steel. Hoops shall be welded to fit tightly around the heads to form slip covers for the body hoop. The head shall be held in place by two round wire straps applied tautly, at right angles to each other and centered over the top, body, and bottom. Each strap shall be held in place by two staples driven into the bottom of the drum.

5.2.1.2.3 Fiberboard drum. The product shall be packed in a fiberboard drum constructed in accordance with type II, grade A, of PPP-D-723. The drum shall be strapped with two 1/4 inch flat steel straps applied at right angles to each other and centered over the top, sides, and bottom.

5.2.1.2.4 Wirebound wood box. The product shall be packed in a wirebound wood box, constructed, and closed in accordance with style 1, 2, or 3, class 2, type 2 of PPP-B-585. The box shall be lined in accordance with 5.2.1.1.3.

5.2.2 Level C. The shipping container shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules as applicable.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

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5.3.1 Civil agencies.

5.3.1.1 Unit containers. Any commercial labeling that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder will be acceptable. In addition, the cheese wrapper shall bear the following applicable information:

(a) Made from pasteurized milk, or
(b) Made from unpasteurized milk.

5.3.1.1.1 Each cheese shall be identified with the following information on the wrapper by suitable marking or labeling:

Name of product
Officially designated code number or name and address of manufacturer
Factory number
Vat number
Date of manufacture

5.3.1.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123, and in addition, shall include the following:

Name of product
Number of units packed and total net weight of each container
Name and address of manufacturer, packer, or distributor
Vat number
Inspection mark (to be affixed by inspector)

5.3.2 Military agencies.

5.3.2.1 Labeling. Labeling shall be as specified in 5.3.1.1 and 5.3.1.1.1.

5.3.2.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and with additional information as specified in 5.3.2.2.1 and 5.3.2.2.1.1.

5.3.2.2.1 Additional marking. The following information, as applicable, shall be printed or legibly stenciled in letters not less than one inch high on the shipping container.

PERISHABLE-KEEP REFRIGERATED

5.3.2.2.1.1 Containers containing print loaves or rindless cheese shall be marked with the following additional information:

SPACE BOXES FOR VENTILATION

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6. NOTES

6.1 Technical information. For best keeping quality, store cheese in a dry room at a temperature between 32° and 40°F. Avoid storage practices which are conducive to condensation and thus possible mold development on the cheese or wrapper.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Grade, class, style and size of product required (see 1.2 and 3.3). (U.S. grade B is generally used for cooking.)
(c) When final inspection is other than at destination (see 4.3.3).
(d) When chemical analyses are required (see 4.5.1).
(e) When in-process examination is not required (see 4.4.3).
(f) Selection of the applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(g) When individual precut loaves are required (see 5.1.1.2).

6.3 Technical information concerning loaves of rindless cheddar cheese. Cuts (regardless of shape or size), derived from blocks of natural rindless cheese, are subject to mold and yeast growth to a greater degree than on the wheels or blocks cured within the original wrapper. To minimize such undesirable growth, considerable care must be taken during the cutting and wrapping of the cheese to avoid contamination, and the packaged cheese must be kept under refrigeration to minimize the rate of surface spoilage on the cheese. Maintenance of low relative humidity during packaging operation should minimize the condition necessary for growth of surface spoilage organisms. Commercial practices for use of this style packaging of cheese is to move the product to the consumer within a period of 3 months after packaging with good control concerning storage during this period. Product with oldest date or product showing evidence of surface spoilage should always be used first. Frequent inspection should be made to determine that surface spoilage has not started.

6.4 Destination inspection (civil agencies). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition, identity and quantity only.

6.5 (Military agencies). Based on condition known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15, NAVSUPINST 4030.28, AFR 71-6, MCO 4030.14D or DSAR 4145.7.

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DP - SS

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Army - GL

Project No. 8910-0332

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA-FSS
VA-DMS
HEW-FDA, NIH
AGR-AMS

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